

Phased Sprint Delivery Plan

TEAM IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

USAMRIID Information Management Division

Contract No. HT9425-23-F-0002

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This plan serves as the team's operational guide for implementing the Phased Sprint Delivery Plan governance model across the USAMRIID IMD IM/IT Support Services contract. Initial rollout applies to the Applications Development/SharePoint team.

What This Plan Covers

- How the model works and why it matters
- Defined roles and responsibilities for Program Managers, Team Leads, and Developers
- Azure DevOps (ADO) board standards and daily expectations
- Governance review cadence
- Scope management and change control process
- Risk escalation expectations
- Training requirements

2. HOW THE MODEL WORKS

The Phased Sprint Delivery Plan model operates on two levels simultaneously. These are not competing systems — they are complementary layers that answer different questions.

PROGRAM LEVEL	TEAM LEVEL (Agile)
Managed by: Program Manager - Contract deliverables - Program milestones - Government reporting - Risk management - Scope adherence <i>"Are we delivering the agreed-upon outcomes?"</i>	Managed by: Team Leads - Sprint execution & standups - Schedule adherence - Change control - Backlog prioritization - Work item tracking - Technical reviews - Defect management - Continuous improvement <i>"How are we completing the work?"</i>

Azure DevOps Work Hierarchy

All work must be organized in ADO using the following three-tier hierarchy so that any stakeholder — developer, Team Lead, or Government Lead — can trace work back to a program objective:

Tier	Represents	Examples
EPIC	Contract deliverables, major program objectives, government priorities	Application Modernization, Security Compliance Enhancements
FEATURE	Major capabilities, functional requirements, planned releases	User Authentication, Dashboard Reporting, Audit Logging
USER STORY / WORK ITEM	Individual development tasks, enhancements, defects, technical work	Add MFA, Fix dashboard filter, Create audit log export

Government lead review Epic-level status. Team Leads manage Feature-level progress. Developers own their User Stories and work items daily.

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

The following are the operational expectations for each role.

PROGRAM MANAGER

- Maintains contract-level oversight — ensures all work performed aligns with the PWS, contractual deliverables, and approved scope
- Serves as the formal contractor representative responsible for HR functions, personnel actions, staffing decisions, and team member management — these functions do not fall within the Government Lead's authority
- Provides a escalation path for issues that cannot be resolved at the team or Government Lead level, including contractual disputes, resource conflicts, or performance concerns
- Participates in bi-weekly Program Reviews and monthly Government Status Reviews to maintain awareness of delivery health at the program level
- Monitors contract-level metrics — deliverable completion, milestone status, scope changes, and risk trends — and ensures government reporting requirements are met
- Acts as the primary liaison between the contractor team and contracting officials (CO/COR) for any contract modifications, funding actions, or compliance matters

TEAM LEAD

Communication & Escalation

- Reinforce proactive communication — developers must raise risks before they become schedule impacts
- Escalate blockers, scope concerns, and technical risks to PM/Government Lead immediately — not at the next status meeting
- Ensure team understands: early communication gives the team options; late communication creates emergencies

Board & Scope Management

- Conduct weekly ADO board health reviews — monitor aging work items, bottlenecks, and blocked items
- Conduct weekly backlog reviews — verify priorities align with approved objectives before work begins
- Team Leads are expected to keep ADO boards current and accurate at all times to support this visibility
- Coordinate and lead scrum ceremonies in the Scrum Master capacity, including sprint planning, sprint reviews, backlog refinement sessions, and retrospectives
- Prevent unauthorized scope expansion at the epic/sprint level — no new epics or sprint-level scope changes begin without Government Lead review and approval; individual work items within an approved sprint do not require separate approval
- Ensure acceptance criteria are defined before work items enter active development

Training & Coaching

- Schedule and track developer training module completion
- Reinforce Agile principles in standups and team meetings through practical application
- Participate in weekly Team Lead Governance Review with Government Lead and PM

DEVELOPER

Daily ADO Board Responsibilities

- Update all assigned work items daily — status must reflect actual progress, not end-of-sprint cleanup
- Move work items through the workflow as work progresses: Backlog → In Progress → In Review → Done
- Document blockers in the work item immediately when they are identified

Standup Expectations

- Communicate openly about schedule risks, technical challenges, and dependency issues
- Participation from all team members are required.
- If a task may miss its target date or require more effort than planned — say so at standup that day
- Work from prioritized backlog items only — seek clarification when requirements are unclear
- Raise scope concerns immediately to Team Lead — do not begin work on unapproved requests

Participate in product backlog refinement sessions, including providing work estimates for prospective backlog items

GOVERNMENT LEAD (TPOC)

Daily Project Oversight

- Functions as the primary program-level lead — drives epic- and sprint-level prioritization based on developer estimates and IT governance direction; Customer and Dev Team collaboratively set exact sprint scope; Team Lead manages day-to-day execution and keeps the team focused on mission-aligned objectives
- Maintains continuous awareness of what is in progress, what is blocked, and what is coming next — Team Leads are expected to keep ADO boards current and accurate at all times to support this visibility
- May engage with Team Leads at a cadence of their choosing to stay informed of project status; Team Leads are responsible for proactively escalating emerging risks and delivery concerns rather than awaiting inquiry
- Drives task prioritization within the approved scope of work — epic- and whole-sprint-level prioritization. The team takes direction from the Government Lead on what to work on and in what order, within the boundaries of the contract
- Participates in the monthly Government Status Review and bi-weekly Program Reviews; may request ad hoc check-ins with Team Leads at any time based on mission need

Scope and Change Authority

- Has authority to identify new requirements and direct work within the existing approved scope — the team responds to Government Lead direction as the government's operational voice on this contract
- Any direction that introduces work outside the current contract scope — regardless of how it is framed — must be routed through the Program Manager
- Collaborates with the Program Manager on all scope decisions to ensure that government priorities can be executed within contract constraints;
- Plays a central role in confirming that completed work meets government expectations and that the team remains focused on the right priorities — acceptance of deliverables flows through the Customer (Product Owner)

Partnership Expectation

The Government Lead directs work at the program/macro level — determining which priorities and systems get built — while the contracted team executes at the operational/micro level. The Team Lead receives tasks and fields day-to-day questions, escalating to the Government Lead only as needed (per PWS 3.5.1.11, Task 11). The Program Manager protects the contract, ensuring

decisions stay within scope, resources are managed appropriately, and the team has what it needs to deliver. This division of responsibility is intentional and essential to the program's success.

4. DAILY STANDUP — PURPOSE AND EXPECTATIONS

Daily standups are already in place. This section reinforces the intent and expected behavior.

A Standup IS	A Standup IS NOT
• A team coordination meeting • A forum to surface blockers early • The forum to identify risks before they affect delivery • A place to coordinate work across team members • A place to flag dependencies and constraints Key Message: If you believe a task may miss a target date, become blocked, or require more effort than planned — communicate it immediately. Early communication gives the team options. Late communication creates emergencies.	• A status report to management • A meeting to explain completed work in detail • A performance evaluation • An opportunity to avoid raising problems • Optional — attendance and honesty are expected

5. AZURE DEVOPS BOARD STANDARDS

Azure DevOps is the single source of truth for all work on this contract. Board accuracy is not optional — it directly supports government visibility and program reporting.

Standard Workflow

BACKLOG	IN PROGRESS	IN REVIEW	DONE
Approved, prioritized work not yet started	Actively being worked — updated daily	Code complete — awaiting review or testing	Accepted, verified complete

Two-Tier Board Structure

The workflow above reflects the feature/request-level board used for status reporting and government visibility. In addition, teams will maintain a task-level board (Backlog > In Progress > Done, with a Blocked flag) for day-to-day execution tracking of individual work items beneath each feature.

Board Health Test

Anyone reviewing the board at any time should immediately be able to answer:

- What work is in progress right now?
- What work is blocked and why?
- What work was completed recently?
- What work is planned next?

If any of these questions cannot be answered from the board alone, the board is not current.

Work Item Update Rules

Rule	Expectation
Update frequency	Every business day — not end of sprint
Blocker documentation	Document in the work item the same day the blocker is identified
Column movement	Move the card as soon as the status actually changes — not in advance or in arrears
Acceptance criteria	Must be defined before a work item moves to In Progress
Aging items	Any item In Progress for more than 5 business days without update is escalated to Team Lead

6. GOVERNANCE REVIEW CADENCE

The following review schedule applies to all teams. These are standing commitments, not ad hoc events.

Frequency	Review	Attendees	Focus
Daily	Team Standup	All team members	Blockers, risks, daily coordination
Bi-Weekly	Program Review	PM, Team Leads, Technical Leads, Government POC	Epic/Feature progress, risks, resource concerns, upcoming deliverables, Board status, blockers, aging items, upcoming milestones
Monthly	Government Status Review	PM, Team Leads, Government POC	Major accomplishments, deliverable status, risk awareness, planned activities

ADO dashboards and reports will be the primary visual aid for bi-weekly and monthly reviews. Team Leads are responsible for ensuring their board is current before each review.

7. SCOPE MANAGEMENT AND CHANGE CONTROL

Scope discipline is non-negotiable. Every change to the codebase — new features and modifications to existing functionality alike — is a change request. Each must be tracked as a work effort in Azure DevOps and processed through the Change Control steps below before implementation begins. There is no exception for new-feature requests on the basis that they introduce new functionality rather than modifying an existing feature.

Developer Time Allocation

Developer capacity each sprint is allocated across three categories, which determines how much major and minor work can be taken on and is factored into work effort estimates:

- 50% major work efforts
- 25% minor work efforts
- 25% meetings and administrative work

Work Item Intake

Work items follow a consistent intake path regardless of size: the Customer (Product Owner) proposes potential work items; the Developer adds proposed items to the backlog and completes work effort estimates; the estimated item is then provided to the Government Lead for review before it is scheduled into a sprint.

Major vs. Minor Efforts

Major efforts require the full phased sprint delivery process described in this plan — epic-level Government Lead approval, multi-sprint execution, and gate review at completion.

Minor efforts are scoped based on complexity and priority, do not represent a major change to functionality, and are executed per the SDLC procedures, contingent on developer availability within the allocated 25% minor-work capacity.

Change Control Process

#	Step	Action
1	Document	Add the request to the backlog in ADO as a new work item, including requestor, description, date received, and work effort estimate
2	Assess	Team Lead evaluates impact to schedule, resources, and existing priorities — no verbal approvals
3	Review	Team Lead brings assessment to Government Lead before any work begins
4	Decision	Government Lead approves, defers, or rejects the request — decision is documented in ADO
5	Execute	If approved, backlog and sprint priorities are updated; work begins only after this step

No work begins on Major efforts —until Step 4 is complete and documented. This applies regardless of requester seniority, or urgency claims. Every item in the backlog and every sprint deliverable must be traceable to a documented change request.

8. RISK AND ESCALATION FRAMEWORK

Risks must be communicated as soon as they are identified. Waiting for a scheduled status meeting is not acceptable when a risk could affect delivery.

Risk Category	Examples	Escalate To
Schedule Risk	Missed milestones, potential delays, resource shortages	Team Lead → Government TPOC,PM
Technical Risk	Architectural concerns, security issues, significant defects	Team Lead → Government TPOC,PM
Scope Risk	Unplanned work requests, requirement changes, expanding requirements	Team Lead → Government TPOC,PM
Dependency Risk	External approvals pending, third-party access issues, GFE/PIV constraints	Team Lead → Government TPOC,PM for tracking

9. METRICS WE WILL TRACK

The following metrics will be monitored and reported. These are not punitive — they are the leading indicators that tell us whether our process is working.

Category	Metrics Tracked
Delivery	Work completed per sprint, work in progress, backlog size, sprint completion rate
Quality	Defect trends, rework items, review cycle times
Process	Blocked items and aging time, ADO update compliance, training completion rates
Program	Deliverable completion status, milestone achievement, scope change volume, risk trends

10. TRAINING Recommendations

All team members are advised to complete the following free training as a foundation for this rollout. Modules average 30 minutes and can be incorporated into normal work schedules. Team members interested in deeper training or formal certifications (e.g., PSM, CSM, AZ-400) are encouraged to reach out to the Program Manager to discuss options.

Training Module / Resource Link	Audience	Completion Target
Azure DevOps: Work Item Management Manage Work Items — Microsoft Learn	All developers	Within 30 days
Azure DevOps: Backlog and Sprint Management Backlogs & Sprints — Microsoft Learn	Developers + Team Leads	Within 30 days
Free Agile Courses Library (multi-topic) Top Free Agile Courses — Udemy	All team members	Self-paced
Azure DevOps Boards Fundamentals (YouTube, free) Complete Azure DevOps Boards Training for Beginners https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rXwUSCDH59Y	All developers	Within 30 days
Azure DevOps Zero to Hero — full walkthrough of Boards, Repos, Pipelines (YouTube, free) https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/devops-lab/azure-devops-zero-to-hero-tutorial	Developers + Team Leads	Self-paced
Agile Scrum Full Course (YouTube, free) Simplilearn — Agile Scrum Full Course in 4 Hours https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VFQtSqChlsk	All team members	Self-paced
Scrum Fundamentals — short intro (YouTube, free) Scrum 101: The Fundamentals of the Agile Scrum Methodology https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ojpTDcdm0vQ	All team members	Within 30 days

11. WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

This initiative is successful when the following conditions are consistently met:

- Risks and blockers are identified and communicated before they affect delivery — not after
- ADO boards reflect accurate, current status at any point in time without prompting
- No work begins on unapproved requests — scope discipline is maintained across all teams
- Sprint completion rates are predictable and schedule surprises are rare
- Government stakeholders have clear, data-driven visibility into project health at all times
- Team Leads and developers understand not just how to use Agile and ADO, but why these practices exist

Success is achieved when project leadership, team leads, developers, and government stakeholders all have a shared understanding of priorities, progress, risks, and expected outcomes.

Questions about this plan should be directed to the Program Manager. This document will be reviewed and updated as the program evolves.